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CODE FORMATTING WITH BLACK



Code formatting is applying a set of rules to source code to give it a certain appearance. Although unimportant to the computer parsing your program, code formatting is vital for readability, which is necessary for maintaining your code. If your code is difficult for humans (whether it's you or a co-worker) to understand, it will be hard to fix bugs or add new features. Formatting code isn't a mere cosmetic issue. Python's readability is a critical reason for the language's popularity.

This chapter introduces you to Black, a code formatting tool that can automatically format your source code into a consistent, readable style without changing your program's behavior. Black is useful, because it's tedious to manually format your code in a text editor or IDE. You'll first learn about the rationalization for the code style choices Black makes. Then you'll learn how to install, use, and customize the tool.